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Lyft to add autonomous shuttles in 2026 as Uber inks more self-driving deals

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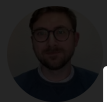
Mobileye's tech is what powers the Holon shuttles, though Lyft told Bloomberg that these aren't the same deals.

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Lyft partners with May Mobility, Mobileye to bring autonomous vehicles to the app

It seems Lyft is hoping to catch up to Uber's string of autonomous vehicle partnerships.

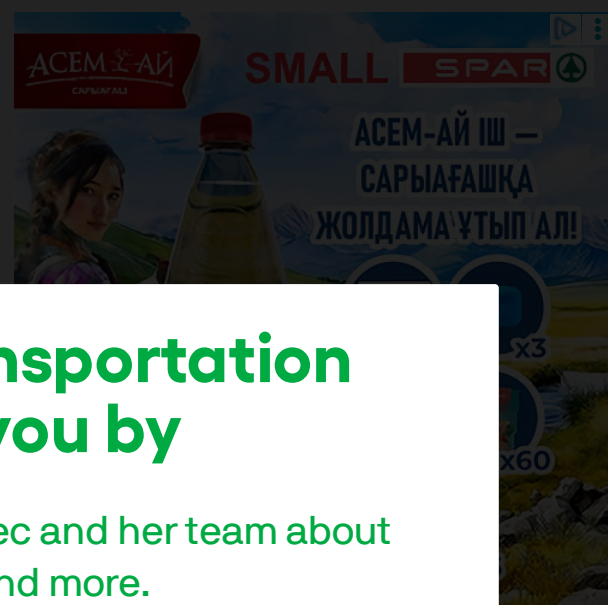
Lyft announced Wednesday three separate partnerships — with startup May Mobility, automated driving company Mobileye, and smart dashcam firm Nexar — all aimed at establishing a foothold in the autonomous vehicle market.

In the meantime, Lyft is also looking to expand its fleet with its own autonomous vehicles. The company has been testing its self-driving cars in several cities, including San Francisco, Los Angeles, and New York City.

Lyft's move into autonomous vehicles comes as the company faces competition from Uber, which has been aggressively pursuing partnerships with AV companies. Lyft's CEO, Logan Katz, said in a statement that the company is "excited to be part of the AV revolution" and that it is "committed to making sure our users have the best possible experience."

This isn't Lyft's first time delving into autonomous vehicles. The company previously provided a robotaxi service — always with a human safety driver behind the wheel — in Las Vegas via a partnership with Motional. It had a similar agreement in Austin and Miami with Argo AI. However, Motional paused that partnership in May after slashing its workforce, and Argo AI shut down in 2022. Lyft had a stake in Argo, and took a \$135.7 million hit when the company folded.

Uber, meanwhile, has been busy snatching up deals with top AV companies across the robotaxi,



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May Mobility + Lyft, starting in 2025

May Mobility has made a name for itself rolling out [autonomous micro-transit services](#) mainly in geofenced areas around the U.S. The startup's shuttles operate within campuses and to designated stops along fixed routes in cities like Ann Arbor, Michigan; Arlington, Texas; Peachtree

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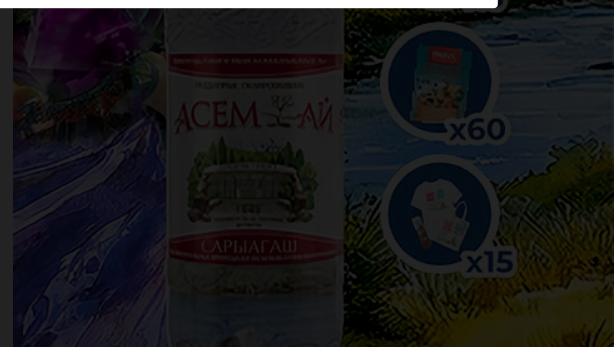
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In a statement, May did note that initial deployments will use safety drivers in the front seat, with plans to transition to fully driverless over time.

Creating Mobility

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“The ne
cloud, or the demand gateway as we call it, to
connect into the different ride-hailing, ride-pooling,
and public transportation networks of the world,”
Christian Lichtmannecker, head of AV at Mobileye’s
Mobility-as-a-Service business development unit,
told TechCrunch.

In other words, any fleet of vehicles that already has
Mobileye Drive onboard — which today includes
certain Volkswagen, Schaeffler, and Benteler Holon
models — will be able to plug into the Lyft network in
the future. Lichtmannecker said this allows both
small and large fleet operators to get seamless
access to Lyft’s platform and network of riders.

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“Lyft’s aim is to connect AVs, drivers, riders, and partners to create new opportunities for all,” Lyft CEO David Risher said in a statement. “Our rideshare network will continue to evolve as millions of people will have the opportunity to earn billions of dollars whether they choose to drive, put their AVs into service, or both.”

Neither Lyft nor Mobileye shared when or where the first Mobileye-powered vehicles would show up on the Lyft app, but Lichtmannecker noted the two are in talks with operating and OEM partners today.

Mobileye is testing its Drive technology in Austin, Detroit, and Orlando. The company is also testing

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Now, Nexar and Lyft think that by combining forces, they’ll be able to give OEMS and AV companies even better insights.

The two companies will pair Nexar’s more than 45 petabytes of real-world footage spanning 200 million miles driven monthly with Lyft’s historical and freshly anonymized and aggregated marketplace data to create “a comprehensive and robust dataset for AV technology development.”

Lyft and Nexar did not share how they plan to share revenue in this partnership. The companies also didn't say whether Lyft will offer Nexar dashcams at a discount to Lyft drivers or even give drivers a cut for collecting data on the company's behalf, though a Nexar spokesperson said drivers need to agree to participate.

The deal comes just a couple of months after Zach Greenberger left his role as chief business officer at Lyft to become the [CEO of Nexar](#).

Topics: [autonomous vehicles](#) [Lyft](#) [May Mobility](#)

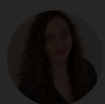
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Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch, where she covers Tesla and Elon Musk's broader empire,...

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Lyft to launch Mobileye-powered robotaxis ‘as soon as 2026,’ starting

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Ride-hail giant Lyft plans to bring fully autonomous robotaxis, powered by Mobileye, to its app “as soon as 2026” in Dallas, with more markets to follow, TechCrunch has exclusively learned.

The news comes a day before Lyft reports its fourth-quarter financial results, coinciding with Waymo’s preparations to launch a commercial robotaxi service with [Uber in Austin](#) and, later, [Atlanta](#). Tesla has also shared plans to start an autonomous ride-hail operation in [Austin in June](#).

Marubeni, a Japanese conglomerate with experience managing fleets, will own and finance

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Latest in Transportation

the Mobileye-equipped vehicles that will show up on Lyft's ride-hailing app. While Lyft has not yet disclosed which carmaker it is partnering with for the launch, Mobileye's advanced driver-assistance technology is [already integrated](#) into vehicles from Audi, Volkswagen, Nissan, Ford, General Motors, and more.

Lyft also didn't share how many vehicles it would launch in Dallas to start, but Jeremy Bird, Lyft's executive vice president of driver experience, told TechCrunch that the plan is to scale to thousands of vehicles across multiple cities after the Texas debut.

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Mobileye served as the intermediary between Lyft and Marubeni, said Bird. For Lyft's asset-light business model, finding a partner to commit to owning the fleet is crucial.

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“Mobileye’s got the technology and the relationship with the OEMs, and we have the platform, so it’s the ownership of the fleet that’s the big missing piece,” Bird told TechCrunch. “And when you have

somebody manage the fleet, you’re willing to play the game for

Marube help manage the fleet. It’s high. Fleet management is a vehicle experience, charging, as well as way to

Bird noted that Lyft is in talks with every major autonomous carmaker to bring them on to the platform. The company probably wants to kick those conversations into gear as its archrival Uber snatches up partnerships with other AV companies. Aside from Waymo, Uber has announced deals with [Wayve](#), [Avride](#), [Serve Robotics](#), [Nuro](#), [Aurora Innovation](#), [Waabi](#), and others.

Outside of its Mobileye deal, Lyft has only announced plans to launch [AVs with May Mobility in Atlanta](#) this year.

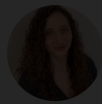
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